current highest temperatures experienced, a 2°C increase would usher in a "new climate regime" unlike anything humans have seen before.

Subsequent research has shown that the 1.5 °C target will probably be exceeded in the 21st century, and that this will make it tougher for warming to be limited to below 2 °C. In 2023, the IPCC produced a Synthesis Report on Climate Change. Its findings were alarming. Unless we radically reduce our greenhouse gas emissions, it is likely that by the end of the century the world is heading for 2.7 °C (4.9 °F) to 4.4 °C (7.9 °F) above pre-industrial levels. This has led to predictions that there will be increases in climate hazards in every region of the world. Perhaps unsurprisingly, in the World Economic Forum's 2025 Global Risks Report, the top three risks over the next 10 years are extreme weather events, biodiversity loss and ecosystem collapse, and critical changes to Earth systems.

The IPCC also appealed to individuals to do their part to lower CO_2 emissions. Land use, energy, cities, and industry are the major areas in which the IPCC suggests change is necessary: people should embrace electric cars; walk and bicycle more; and fly less often, as planes produce a significant proportion of greenhouse gases. The IPCC also encouraged people to buy less meat, milk, cheese, and butter, as reduced demand for these products should lead to lower emissions by the meat and dairy processing industries. While global agreements such as Kyoto and Paris have dominated the conversation, it is now clear that any and all methods to lower CO_2 emissions must be pursued.

"We have presented governments with pretty hard choices. We have pointed out the enormous benefits of keeping to 1.5°C."

Professor Jim Skea

Chair of the IPCC